



Partner Support Handbook



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1. Introduction

This handbook is intended to provide customers with information on ARM's support procedure. Our goal is to provide you with technical assistance on ARM related issues during your product development cycle, thus helping you bring your product to market in the fastest possible time. Please read this guide before contacting us. It will help you make the best use of our support service and help us process your request quickly and efficiently.

To use ARM Support, your organization must have a valid ARM Support and Maintenance Agreement for the product on which you require support. If you do not have a valid Support and Maintenance Agreement or you need to renew your Support and Maintenance Agreement, you can contact your local ARM sales office. For ARM sales office locations, consult our web site at <http://www.arm.com>.

2. ARM Support Services

The ARM Support Organization is staffed by a team of dedicated Applications Engineers whose sole responsibility is providing customer support. Because the group is dedicated to providing support, they are not bound by internal project schedules and other business demands that might otherwise distract them from their support and training roles.

Our Applications Engineers are organized into teams focusing on specific areas such as Development System Tools, Fabric IP, Physical IP and Processor IP. Because of this focus, our Applications Engineers have the extensive knowledge required to answer detailed technical questions about the products for which they are responsible in addition to general knowledge of the other products.

ARM's Support Team is a global organization with engineers located in Asia, UK and the United States. Support cases are tracked using a central database that ensures cases are answered promptly and accurately across each region and worldwide.

ARM's Support Team works closely with development engineering to acquire detailed knowledge of new products prior to product launch. We also provide valuable feedback that promotes continuous improvement to ARM's product offerings.

ARM's team of Applications Engineers helps customers get the most from their ARM technical investment by accelerating customer education, improving productivity and reducing their time to market.

3. Goals & Objectives of ARM's Support Organization

The goals and objectives of the ARM Support Organization include:

- Provide updates and information about inquiries.
- Provide accurate and timely responses.
- Provide quality, dependable service.
- Provide confidential service.
- Promote continuous review and improvement to ARM's products.
- Reduce time-to-market.
- Provide education and training for customers.

4. Scope of ARM Support

Our purpose in providing technical support is to help you solve specific, definable problems related to ARM's products. The scope of the support organization is limited to providing support for ARM's products, we cannot help debug complete systems or provide assistance or training on non-ARM developed tools or intellectual property (IP).

5. Useful Information

5.1 Documentation

Documentation and general information on ARM's products can be found in various locations, including:

- **Online Resources**

The initial step in locating information about ARM's products is to visit our web site at <http://www.arm.com>. The web site includes resources such as Technical Reference Manuals, Application Notes, White Papers, and FAQs. All are available to download.

- **Development Systems Tools Documentation**

Extensive documentation is included with each product purchased from ARM. Upgrades, software patches and additional examples are provided through the ARM web site as they become available.

- **IP Deliverables**

IP deliverables include documentation. These documents typically reside in the /DOCS directory. Because those documents included with IP deliverables are confidential, they are not available directly from the ARM web site. It is common for companies to have a software vault where ARM deliverables are kept. If this is the case, the documentation might not be publicly accessible and you must contact your company administrator for information about the file locations and their access procedures.

- **Training Courses**

Since 1994, ARM has been the provider of choice for training in ARM-Powered[®] design solutions. Our material is written by the acknowledged world experts in ARM hardware and software. Our courses provide engineers with a quick and easy way to learn about ARM products. Because our training team is drawn from the world's largest and most experienced pool of ARM technology experts, you are assured relevant information, delivered by professional trainers.

ARM teaches open courses at venues all around the world at regular intervals. See the course schedule on our web site for up-to-date details about the next course nearest you. Alternatively, ARM can provide a private, closed course, tailored specifically for your engineers, at training facilities of your choice.

5.2 Support Availability

ARM provides support during regular office hours Monday through Friday in select regions. National holidays are observed. A list of national holidays is provided on the ARM web site.

6. Obtaining Support

ARM provides email support for development System Tools, Fabric IP and Processor IP. Support for Artisan products is provided through an online web page.

6.1 Support for Development System Tools, Fabric IP and Processor IP

Support for ARM's Development System Tools, Fabric IP and Processor IP is provided through dedicated email addresses. Each address is targeted at a specific product area and directed to the appropriate Applications Engineers. All support inquiries are logged into a global tracking system that is visible to all ARM Support Centers. When a case is logged, it is assigned a unique case number that is made available to you. We make best business efforts to respond to most cases within one working day.

Use the following list of email addresses to determine the correct target support email address for your ARM product type:

Using a dedicated email address for each ARM product type ensures that all questions are answered promptly, irrespective of whether a particular Applications Engineer is available. Do not contact engineers directly.

Product	Email Address
ARM Development System Tools and Software Products	support-sw@arm.com
ARM Development Boards	support-cards@arm.com
ARM Processor Cores	support-cores@arm.com
ARM PrimeCells	support-primecells@arm.com
AMBA	support-amba@arm.com
ARM PrimeXsys Platform Support	support-primexsys@arm.com
General Questions	support@arm.com
ARM Development Systems Tool licensing	license.support@arm.com
ARM Data Engines	support-optimode@arm.com
ARM Single Use Design Licensees (SUDL)	support-sudl@arm.com
ARM ESL Tools	support-esl@arm.com

Although it is strongly recommended that you contact support via email, a telephone hotline is also available. The telephone hotline numbers are available from the ARM web site.

6.2 Support for Artisan Libraries

Over 2,000 companies use ARM's Artisan Access library products. As its customer base has grown, so has the diversity in needs for different levels of support. In response, three support options have been developed from which customers can choose:

- **AccessBasic**
This program includes support for all Access library products in one specific foundry process.
- **AccessFirst**
Instead of being priced per foundry/process, this program covers all Access library products in all foundry processes.
- **AccessCustom**
This program starts with AccessFirst as a foundation and can be designed and priced to fit your specific requirements.

Support for these products is provided on line at the ARM Artisan web site.

6.3 Support Entitlement

ARM provides support to companies who have valid Support and Maintenance Agreements for a specific product. In the event ARM is unable to determine that an agreement exists, the resolution of your case could be delayed because we might need to request additional information. To prevent delays, ensure that you provide the product name and serial numbers, where applicable. Also, provide us with a company email address instead of a personal or free web based email address because these are difficult to verify and they are not secure.

If no Support and Maintenance Agreement exists, ARM reserves the right to deny support.

In the case of ARM tools or IP obtained from a company other than ARM, such as tools distributors or silicon vendors, support inquiries must be directed to those companies. A list of contact details for software distributors is available from the ARM web site.

7 Support Procedure

When you submit a support request, ARM follows a procedure that ensures it is dealt with quickly and efficiently. We strive to provide the highest level of care when processing your request. We aim to resolve your case in the shortest amount of time. To make this possible, we ask for your cooperation in observing the following procedure:

7.1 Prior to logging a case

Before you contact Support Services, read the supplied documentation and check the ARM web site for relevant FAQs. Documentation is also provided as part of your deliverables. If you are unable to locate relevant documentation, it might be that your company has a central location where this is kept. Because our deliverables are confidential they might not be openly available within your company. Contact the person in your company who receives the ARM deliverables and request the documentation be made available to you.

If you reviewed the appropriate documentation and are still unable to answer your question, send an email to the appropriate support alias. Ensure that you use a valid company email. Note: If you do not use a company email address, it can delay our response because it makes it difficult for us to verify that you have a valid ARM Support and Maintenance Agreement.

7.2 Logging a case

The product on which you require support determines the method to use when logging a case.

7.2.1 Support for Development Tools, Fabric IP and Processor IP

We strongly recommend that support requests are submitted to ARM through email for these products. When we receive an email, it is logged into our global tracking database and given a unique case number. The case is then assigned to one of our Applications Engineers who begins work to answer the request. The case is referenced using the assigned case number. We attempt to respond to questions within 24 hours, although complicated cases might require longer periods to resolve.

Ensure that you include within your email all relevant information including:

- Identify yourself by full name and email address so that our response will be directed correctly to you.
- Identify the product you require information about.
- List the revision and serial number for the product.
- Provide a clear and comprehensive description of your question.
Be as specific as possible in your description because we cannot give precise answers to general questions.
- Include any attachments relevant to resolving your case.
If attachments are very large then they can be transferred to a secure location through FTP.
- Example templates for case logging are available from the ARM web site.

7.2.2 Support for Artisan Products

To access support on line for Physical IP products:

1. Point your browser to <http://www.artisan.com>
2. Click **LOGIN**
3. Enter your *user name* and *password*.
Register as a new customer if you do not have an account with ARM PIPD's (Physical IP Division) online support system.
4. Select your request type:
Click **New Technical Request** for technical requests, or
Click **New Business Request** for non-technical requests.

Requests submitted through the online support system enable faster and more efficient handling of your requests. If however, you are unable to submit your request on line, you can submit your request through email. Use the email support alias support-pipd@arm.com.

For further information, see the ARM web site,

7.3 Ongoing Communication

For all communications concerning specific case support inquiries, it is essential to quote the case number if you are responding by email. This allows ARM to quickly identify the case and track its progress.

ARM endeavors to provide answers as quickly and efficiently as possible. ARM provides a methodical approach to determine the root cause of problems. As part of the case investigation, ARM may need to ask specific questions for clarification. ARM might also request that specific tests be performed. To resolve support inquiries as quickly as possible, you must directly answer every question and provide feedback concerning the results of requested tests.

Although ARM typically provides support through email or online, a telephone or conference call may be required in some cases. These telephone or conference calls will be used when necessary to resolve specific issues. If you need to talk directly with an Applications Engineer, send a request to the support alias. ARM will coordinate a telephone call between you and the appropriate engineer. In this way, we ensure the correct ARM representatives are on the telephone call.

7.4 Case Resolution

Acknowledgment of case resolution is appreciated. When ARM receives case resolution acknowledgement, ARM closes the support case. In the event ARM does not receive communication concerning resolution of a support case, the case may still be closed by ARM.

7.5 Escalation Procedure

To ensure that we provide prompt responses to customer queries, cases sent to ARM Support are logged into our worldwide database. Cases are reviewed for technical accuracy and reports are generated to identify those cases that are not responded to within a reasonable time. These reports are made available to the Applications Engineering Managers who take prompt action to re-allocate resources to ensure that all cases are resolved in a timely and efficient manner.

We strive to provide quality service with a short turnaround time. If you feel that a case requires escalation, you can send an email to: escalation@arm.com. This email is received and promptly read by an Applications Engineering Manager.

8. Feedback Procedure

Feedback can be provided to ARM at any point, independent of the support mechanism. All feedback is logged and acted upon. Feedback can be submitted through the email address: feedback@arm.com.

Note: Do not send support requests to this address.